



◁ Bell-Boeing V22 prototype 1989

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 6,150 shp Rolls Royce T406 turboshaft

Top speed 316 mph (508 km/h)

The V22 was the first tiltrotor aircraft to enter operational service. It was developed as a multimission assault transport for the US Marine Corps for special forces and combat search and rescue operations.

▷ EH101 Merlin HM1 prototype 1987

Origin UK/Italy

Engine 3 x 2,100 shp Rolls-Royce Turbomeca RTM322-01

Top speed 167 mph (268 km/h)

The Merlin HM1 aircraft with specified Blue Kestrel radar, dipping sonar, and defensive systems finally started serving the Royal Navy in 2000. A modernized HM2 configuration is due to enter service in 2013.



◁ Messerschmitt-Bölkow-Blohm MBB Bo108 1988

Origin Germany

Engine 2 x 450 shp Allison 250-C20R-3 turboshaft

Top speed 158 mph (254 km/h)

In the 1980s Messerschmitt-Bölkow-Blohm began development of a new mid-size helicopter to succeed their successful Bo105. The resulting five- to six-seat Bo108 had a choice of power plants and an advanced-technology hingeless main rotor.



△ Sikorsky HH-60G Pave Hawk 1988

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 1,630 shp GE T700-GE-701 turboshaft

Top speed 224 mph (360 km/h)

Derived from the US Army UH-60 Black Hawk, this machine was specifically developed for a US Air Force combat search and rescue role, recovering personnel by day or night in hostile environments.



△ Schweizer 269C 1989

Origin USA

Engine 190 hp Lycoming HIO-360-D1A piston engine

Top speed 109 mph (175 km/h)

Hughes Helicopters developed a two-seat light helicopter in the 1950s. Military interest in the 1960s resulted in the three-seat 269C, with an upgraded engine and increased diameter rotors. The US rights were sold to Schweizer in 1983.